



GRANTS & PROPOSALS

Donor Grant Proposal & Logical Framework Template

A standardized matrix for structuring donor funding proposals and managing grant compliance reporting

DOCX-STYLE TEMPLATE GUIDE · 850 KB · GRANTS EDITION

Your Partner in Compliance, Research and Sustainable Impact

Donor Grant Proposal & Logical Framework Template

Donors fund clarity. A proposal that clearly links activities to outputs, outcomes and impact — and shows exactly how you'll monitor and report on them — stands a far better chance of approval. This guide outlines the structure our team uses when preparing donor grant proposals and logical frameworks (logframes).

CORE TOOL Logical Framework Matrix (Logframe)	USED BY NGOs, NPOs & donor-funded projects	KEY OUTPUT Fundable, report-ready proposal
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1. Proposal Structure Donors Expect

- Executive summary stating the problem, solution and ask in under a page
- Problem statement backed by data or lived evidence, not assumptions
- Clear theory of change linking your activities to intended impact

Section-by-section language templates for executive summaries, and how to size a realistic budget-to-impact ratio for different donor types, are included in the full template pack.

2. Building the Logical Framework Matrix

The logframe is the backbone donors use to assess and later monitor your project. It typically has four levels:

- Goal / Impact — the long-term change your project contributes to
- Outcome — the specific change your project is directly responsible for
- Outputs — the tangible deliverables your activities produce
- Activities — the concrete actions and resources required

Each level needs indicators, means of verification, and assumptions/risks — our full template provides pre-built indicator examples by sector (health, education, livelihoods, environment).

3. Setting Indicators That Hold Up to Scrutiny

- Make indicators specific, measurable and time-bound
- Separate output indicators (what you delivered) from outcome indicators (what changed as a result)

4. Budget Narrative Basics

- Align every budget line to a specific activity in your logframe
- Clearly separate direct project costs from organisational overheads

Guidance on overhead percentage norms by donor type and how to present co-funding or in-kind contributions is covered in the full grant pack.

5. After Submission: Reporting Readiness

- Set up your KPI tracking sheet before the project even starts, not after
- Calendar donor reporting deadlines alongside your DSD/CIPC compliance dates

Ready to submit a proposal donors say yes to?

SARE Projects Solutions provides full grant application support, donor reporting, narrative report writing and KPI dashboard preparation for NGOs and donor-funded projects.

Send us your project concept and we'll advise on the right structure, free of charge.

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